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§ . . — Draft anchor text + consumer mirror

Field	Value
Revision	1
Created	2026-06-09
Last modified	2026-06-09T00:00:00Z
Status	draft (for operator review before landing in Constitution.md)
Scope	full §11.4.140 anchor + shorter CLAUDE.md/AGENTS.md/QWEN.md/GEMINI.md consumer mirror
Inputs	`RESEARCH.md`, `DESIGN.md` (this directory)

> NOTE: this is DRAFT text written to research/ per the task scope. It is NOT applied to `Constitution.md` / `CLAUDE.md` / `AGENTS.md` / `QWEN.md` in this run (no commit/push/edit of the live governance files). The operator lands it via the §11.4.26 constitution-update pipeline.

A. FULL anchor — to add as a new `###` §11.4.140 … section in `Constitution.md`

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§ . . — Universal action-prefix system (`ACTION_NAME ::`) (User mandate, - -)

Forensic anchor — verbatim user mandate (2026-06-09):

> "When a user prompt STARTS with `ACTION_NAME ::` (e.g. `BACKGROUND :: IMPORTANT: do X...`) the agent MUST replace the `ACTION_NAME ::` prefix with that action's registered expansion text, then execute the rest. For `BACKGROUND ::` the expansion is: 'The following prompt that we will provide MUST BE executed in background in parallel with all main work streams using the subagents-driven development approach! All work done MUST PRODUCE rock solid evidence covered with hard physical proof(s) that all done is working as expected and as specified without any false results and without any bluff!'. The mechanism MUST be UNIVERSAL/extensible — more actions will be added later, each with its own expansion + rules. It MUST work with EVERY CLI agent, be fully decoupled + reusable by every project that includes the constitution submodule, and load + execute out of the box."

Every project under this Constitution MUST support a universal, extensible **action-prefix system**: when a user prompt's FIRST non-blank line starts with an uppercase action token followed by `" :: "` (grammar `^([A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*) ::` — anchored at line start, UPPERCASE-only token, exactly one space on each side of `::`), the agent MUST (1) look the token up in the shared **action registry** (tracked data file `constitution/actions/registry.yaml`, or `$HELIX_ACTION_REGISTRY`); (2) if the token is a registered action, REPLACE the `ACTION_NAME ::` prefix with that action's registered `expansion` text and apply its `rules`; (3) execute the REMAINDER of the prompt under the expanded instruction. The system is the C-preprocessor expand-then-rescan model applied to prompts (a line-anchored single-token macro): detect → substitute the registered expansion → execute the residual.

Two-layer architecture (both mandatory; LAYER 1 is the universal floor). (LAYER 1 — universal, always-on, out-of-the-box) the action-prefix recognition instruction MUST be mirrored into EVERY agent context carrier the constitution maintains (`CLAUDE.md` , `AGENTS.md` , `QWEN.md` , `GEMINI.md` per §11.4.35) so the agent itself recognises and applies the prefix on every CLI agent — Claude Code, Gemini CLI, Qwen Code, OpenAI Codex CLI, GitHub Copilot CLI, Cursor, Aider, Cline, Continue, Roo Code, and any future agent that reads one of those carriers. (LAYER 2 — mechanical, where the agent exposes a pre-submit seam) a prompt-preprocessing hook reading the SAME registry applies the expansion deterministically (Claude Code `UserPromptSubmit` / `UserPromptExpansion` hook injecting the expansion via `additionalContext` ; per-agent slash-command equivalents generated from the registry for Gemini/Qwen/Codex). LAYER 2 is the §11.4.109 anti-forgetting upgrade applied to prompt prefixes — the expansion holds even if model recall lapses; LAYER 1 guarantees the system works everywhere with zero extra setup. Honest §11.4.3 boundary (§11.4.6): transparent mechanical free-form `^PREFIX ::` interception is genuinely available ONLY on Claude Code today; on every other agent the free-form form is honoured by LAYER 1 (the agent self-applies) and the slash-command equivalent is the mechanical convenience — this split is documented, never papered over.

Grammar (mandatory, all hold). (1) Anchored at the start of the first non-blank line ONLY; mid-prose tokens never match. (2) UPPERCASE-only token `[A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*` ; lowercase never matches. (3) Separator is exactly `" :: "` (space-colon-colon-space) — avoids C++ `Foo::Bar` , YAML `key: value` , URLs. (4) Stacked prefixes (`A :: B :: rest`) apply outer-to-inner, left-to-right (expand A, rescan, expand B, then the residual is the task). (5) A leading `\` escapes the prefix (literal, no expansion) so action names can be discussed. (6) An unknown token that matches the grammar shape but is NOT registered is NEVER silently expanded or silently dropped — the agent asks which registered action was meant (§11.4.66 + §11.4.105) or treats it literally; it NEVER invents an expansion (§11.4.6). (7) Any prompt not satisfying the grammar is an ordinary prompt; the system is a no-op.

Registry is the single source of truth + the extension contract. Adding a new action = adding ONE `actions[]` row (`name` , `version` , `summary` ≥6 words per §11.4.91, `expansion` , optional `rules` + `composes_with`) — no code change in either layer (the registry is data, not code). Both layers read the same file (§11.4.93-style single-source-of-truth). The first registry entry is `BACKGROUND` with the

operator's verbatim expansion above; it composes §11.4.20/§11.4.70 (subagent-driven), §11.4.58/§11.4.103 (parallel streams), §11.4.89 (background execution), and §11.4.5/§11.4.69/§11.4.107 (captured physical evidence) + §11.4 (anti-bluff). Decoupled + reusable (§11.4.28): the registry + hook + expander carry zero project-specific data and are consumed by reference (the §11.4.80 `codegraph_*` pattern); a consuming project ships its own registry or inherits the constitution default. Loads out-of-the-box via the §11.4.75 install seam.

Classification: universal (§11.4.17). Composes §11.4 / §11.4.5 / §11.4.6 / §11.4.17 / §11.4.20 / §11.4.28 / §11.4.35 / §11.4.58 / §11.4.66 / §11.4.69 / §11.4.70 / §11.4.75 / §11.4.80 / §11.4.89 / §11.4.91 / §11.4.93 / §11.4.103 / §11.4.105 / §11.4.107 / §11.4.109. Propagation gate `CM-COVENANT-114-140-PROPAGATION` (literal `11.4.140` across the consumer fleet)

- recommended gate `CM-ACTION-PREFIX-SYSTEM` (registry exists + parses + the grammar regex matches/no-matches the canonical fixtures + the LAYER-1 mirror block is present in CLAUDE.md/AGENTS.md/QWEN.md/GEMINI.md + the BACKGROUND expansion text matches the registry verbatim + the Claude `UserPromptSubmit` hook + expander script exist and are executable) + paired §1.1 meta-test mutation (corrupt the BACKGROUND expansion in the registry OR strip the `prefix_regex` OR remove the LAYER-1 mirror block from one carrier → the gate FAILs; strip the literal `11.4.140` → the propagation gate FAILs; gate-code = separate work item).

Canonical authority: constitution submodule `Constitution.md` §11.4.140. Non-compliance is a release blocker. No escape hatch — no `--skip-action-prefix`, `--ignore-prefix`, `--no-registry`, `--invent-expansion-OK`, `--single-layer-only` flag.

B. SHORTER consumer mirror — to add to `CLAUDE.md` / `AGENTS.md` / `QWEN.md` / `GEMINI.md`

(One block, identical text in all four carriers — that identity IS the LAYER-1 universality. Verbatim BACKGROUND expansion is inlined so the most-used action works out-of-the-box even without registry-file access.)

§11.4.140 — Universal action-prefix system (`ACTION_NAME ::`) (User mandate, 2026-06-09). When a user prompt's FIRST non-blank line starts with an uppercase action token followed by `" :: "` (grammar `^([A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*) ::`), you MUST: (1) look the token up in the action registry `constitution/actions/registry.yaml` (or `$HELIX_ACTION_REGISTRY`); (2) if it is a registered action, REPLACE the `ACTION_NAME ::` prefix with that action's `expansion` text and apply its `rules` ; (3) execute the remainder of the prompt under the expanded instruction. Grammar: anchored at the first non-blank line only; UPPERCASE-only token; separator exactly `" :: "` ; stacked prefixes (`A :: B :: rest`) apply outer-to-inner; a leading `\` escapes the prefix (literal, no expansion); an unknown grammar-shaped token is NEVER silently expanded or dropped — ask which registered action was meant (§11.4.66 / §11.4.105) or treat it literally, NEVER invent an expansion (§11.4.6). The registered action **`BACKGROUND`** expands to: *"The following prompt that we will provide MUST BE executed in background in parallel with all main work streams using the subagents-driven development approach! All work done MUST PRODUCE rock solid evidence covered with hard physical proof(s) that all done is working as expected and as specified without any false results and without any bluff!"* (composes §11.4.20 / §11.4.70 subagent-driven, §11.4.58 / §11.4.103 parallel streams, §11.4.89 background execution, §11.4.5 / §11.4.69 / §11.4.107 captured physical evidence, §11.4 anti-bluff). The system is UNIVERSAL (every CLI agent reads this block via its context carrier per §11.4.35), extensible (new action = new registry row), decoupled

- reusable (§11.4.28), and loads out-of-the-box. Classification: universal (§11.4.17). **Canonical authority:** constitution submodule `Constitution.md` §11.4.140. Non-compliance is a release blocker. No escape hatch — no `--skip-action-prefix` , `--ignore-prefix` , `--no-registry` , `--invent-expansion-OK` , `--single-layer-only` flag.

C. Landing checklist (for the operator, via § . . pipeline)

1. `git fetch` + `git pull --ff-only` in the constitution submodule (§11.4.26 step 1 / §11.4.37).
2. Add §11.4.140 (Part A) to `Constitution.md`; add the mirror (Part B) to `CLAUDE.md`, `AGENTS.md`, `QWEN.md`, and a new `GEMINI.md` (the GEMINI.md carrier is added by this anchor so Gemini CLI gets the LAYER-1 floor).
3. Land `actions/registry.yaml` + `actions/SCHEMA.md` + `scripts/hooks/action-prefix-expand.sh` + `scripts/actions/expand_prefix.sh`
   - `scripts/actions/gen_agent_commands.sh` per DESIGN.md §2.
4. Wire `CM-COVENANT-114-140-PROPAGATION` + `CM-ACTION-PREFIX-SYSTEM` gates + the §1.1 paired mutations (TEST_PLAN.md).
5. Re-export `.html` / `.pdf` / `.docx` siblings per §11.4.65; bump revision header per §11.4.44; sync the consumer fleet per §11.4.35.
6. Commit + push to ALL upstreams per §11.4.26 step 4 / §2.1 (no force-push per §11.4.113).